

Document Retention and Destruction Policy

Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order

Document Retention and Destruction Policy

Purpose The purpose of this policy is to establish standards for the creation, retention, storage, protection, and lawful destruction of records of Knights of The Kingdom of Christ Order. The Order shall maintain records necessary for legal compliance, financial accountability, tax reporting, governance, and preservation of important historical and organizational information.

General Principles Records shall be retained for as long as reasonably necessary for business, legal, tax, governance, audit, insurance, or historical purposes. Records may be kept in paper or electronic form, provided they remain accessible, legible, and appropriately protected.

No record shall be destroyed if the Order knows or reasonably believes that the record is relevant to pending or threatened litigation, government inquiry, audit, investigation, insurance claim, disciplinary proceeding, or other legal hold.

Record Categories The following categories of records should be maintained:

1. Permanent records: Articles of Incorporation, bylaws, amendments, IRS determination letters, tax identification records, Board and member minutes, resolutions, incorporator statements, corporate seal records, major contracts of enduring significance, trademark registrations, real property records, and historical charters.
2. Financial records: annual financial statements, general ledgers, audit reports, budgets, bank statements, canceled checks, expense records, invoices, contribution records, grant records, payroll records if any, and supporting tax schedules.
3. Tax records: federal, state, and local tax returns, informational returns, supporting workpapers, exemption applications, and correspondence with taxing authorities.
4. Governance and policy records: committee records, conflict-of-interest disclosures, policy acknowledgments, officer and director rosters, insurance policies, and compliance reports.
5. Membership and operational records: membership applications, rosters, disciplinary records, chapter reports, volunteer forms, event records, and training records.

Suggested Retention Periods Permanent: organizational documents, Board minutes, major governance records, IRS determination letters, and similar foundational records.

At least 7 years: annual returns, supporting tax documentation, financial statements, bank records, expense records, grant and donation substantiation, contracts after expiration unless of permanent significance, insurance records after expiration, and conflict-of-interest disclosure forms.

At least 4 years or longer if required by law: payroll and employment tax records, if the Order has employees.

At least 3 years after closure or resolution: routine correspondence, administrative drafts not of historical significance, and ordinary event files, unless a longer period is prudent.

Storage and Protection *The Chancellor / Secretary and Treasurer, or their designees, shall ensure that records are organized and stored securely. Sensitive records shall be protected from unauthorized access, alteration, theft, or disclosure. Electronic files should be backed up in a secure manner.*

Destruction of Records *When the applicable retention period has expired and no legal hold applies, records may be destroyed in a secure manner appropriate to the type of record. Confidential records should be shredded, securely deleted, or otherwise destroyed in a way that protects private information.*

Administration *The Board may designate officers or committees to supervise compliance with this policy. Questions about retention, destruction, or legal hold issues should be referred to the Board or legal counsel when appropriate.*